





MADE TO BREATHE

We take you inside two forward-thinking breathable homes that have rewritten the rules of sustainable luxury and turned traditional climate wisdom into striking modern, eco-friendly architecture

By RIDHI KALE

True sustainability isn't just a checklist of green features; it is an active dialogue between architecture and the ecosystem, as brilliantly demonstrated by two shortlisted residential projects. Instead of relying on energy-heavy mechanical systems, Khosla Associates' project in Ahmedabad and Taliesyn's design in Bangalore show that eco-friendly luxury comes from zero-resource passive planning. What makes these homes particularly interesting is how they harness regional geography as a design tool, whether it is Khosla Associates utilising an eastern pool and existing neem trees to naturally condition incoming air, or Taliesyn splitting building volumes to manipulate air pressure and force the structure to breathe. By grounding their designs in hyper-local, low-carbon materials like regional clay, Mangalore tiles and native stone, both projects prove that high-end modern architecture can significantly shrink its environmental footprint simply by honouring the microclimate it sits in.